

Word family: **so**

Base word: so

Part of speech: adverb (副詞) / conjunction-like connector (連接用法) / pronoun-like substitute (代替前述內容的用法) / discourse marker (語篇標記)

Useful expressions: so + adjective/adverb, so...that..., so = therefore, I think so, so do I, so-called, so far, so far so good, or so, and so on

Your passage actually contains **three different uses of *so***, which makes this an excellent polyfunctionality word:

> “the train was **so** noisy and crowded **that** I often got home feeling exhausted”

> “Another reason it worked **so** well...”

> “...the ad mentioned practical features ..., **so** it still felt believable.”

A full family sweep shows that **so** has several genuinely important functions. It is not just one meaning.

Meaning 1 in your passage: **so + adjective/adverb = to such a high degree — 如此；這麼；那麼**

> “the train was **so noisy and crowded** ...”

Here, **so** intensifies **noisy** and **crowded**.

繁體中文：**程度非常高；如此 / 這麼.....**

Natural translation:

> “The train was so noisy and crowded...”

「火車**非常嘈雜而且這麼擠迫**.....」

More naturally in the full sentence:

「火車**嘈雜又擠迫得很厲害**.....」

1. **so + adjective/adverb (形容詞 / 副詞) — 如此；這麼；非常**

Practice 1

> “The office was **so noisy**.”

「辦公室**非常**嘈雜 / 這麼嘈雜。」

Practice 2

> “She spoke **so quietly** that I could hardly hear her.”

「她說話**非常**小聲，我幾乎聽不到。」

so = 表示某種性質、狀態或方式達到很高程度

2. **so + adjective/adverb + that + result** (程度 → 結果) — 如此.....以致.....

This is exactly the structure in:

> “The train was **so noisy and crowded that** I often got home feeling exhausted.”

Practice 3 — Original

> “The train was **so noisy and crowded that** I often got home feeling exhausted.”

「火車**嘈雜**又擠迫得令我**經常**回到家時已經筋疲力盡。」

Practice 4

> “The headphones were **so comfortable that** I forgot I was wearing them.”

「這副耳機**舒服**得令我幾乎忘了自己正在戴著它們。」

Practice 5

> “The café was **so busy that** we couldn't find a seat.”

「咖啡店**忙**得 / 擠得連座位也找不到。」

so...that... = 某種程度高到足以產生後面所述結果

This is one of the most important **so** patterns.

Meaning 2 in your passage: **so + adverb** = very / to such a degree — 這麼；如此

> “Another reason it worked **so well**...”

Here:

so well = 這麼好 / 效果這麼好

Practice 6

> “The advertisement worked **so well**.”

「這則廣告**效果這麼好 / 非常有效**。」

Practice 7

> “She explained the idea **so clearly**.”

「她把這個概念解釋得**非常清楚**。」

Again, this belongs to the same degree-intensifying sense as #1.

Meaning 3 in your passage: **so** = therefore / as a result — 所以；因此

> “...the ad mentioned practical features ..., **so** it still felt believable.”

Here **so** does **not** mean “very.”

It links **cause** → **result**.

繁體中文： **所以；因此；因而**

Practice 8 — Original

> “The ad mentioned practical features, **so** it still felt believable.”

「廣告提到了實際功能，**所以**整體仍然令人覺得可信。」

Practice 9

> “The train was delayed, **so** I arrived late.”

「火車延誤了，**所以**我遲到了。」

Practice 10

> “The headphones were comfortable, **so** I kept using them.”

「耳機很舒服，**所以**我繼續使用它們。」

so = 前面的事情造成後面的結果；所以 / 因此

This is a genuinely different function from degree **so**.

4. **so** = in that way / like that — 這樣；如此

A less obvious but useful meaning.

Practice 11

> “Hold the headphones **so**.”

「像**這樣**拿著耳機。」

Practice 12

> “If you arrange it **so**, it will fit.”

「如果你**這樣**擺放，它就能放得下。」

so = 以剛才展示、描述或理解的方式；這樣 / 如此

This use is somewhat more formal or old-fashioned in some contexts, but still alive.

5. **so** = substitute for a statement (代替前面整句內容) — 是這樣；如此；這件事

This is extremely important.

Instead of repeating a whole clause, **so** can replace it.

Practice 13

> “Do you think the product is worth the price?”

> “I think **so**.”

「你覺得這件產品值這個價錢嗎？」

「我想**是**的 / 我想是**這樣**。」

Practice 14

> “Will the train arrive on time?”

> “I hope **so**.”

「火車會準時到嗎？」

「我希望**會**。」

so = 代替前面已經提到的整個肯定內容，避免重複完整句子

Common:

* I think so. = 我想是

* I hope so. = 我希望如此

* I suppose so. = 我想是吧

* It seems so. = 看來如此

6. **not...so / I don't think so — 我想不是；並非如此**

The negative counterpart is very common.

Practice 15

> “Do you think the ad was misleading?”

> “I don't think **so**.”

「你覺得這則廣告有誤導性嗎？」

「我想**不是**。」

Practice 16

> “Is it too expensive?”

> “I don't believe **so**.”

「它太貴嗎？」

「我想**不是**。」

so = 代替前面命題；在否定句中表示「並非如此」

7. **so do I / so am I / so can I (同樣情況) — 我也是**

This is a very important grammatical construction.

Practice 17

> “I like these headphones.”

> “**So do I.**”

「我喜歡這副耳機。」

「**我也是。**」

Practice 18

> “I’m tired.”

> “**So am I.**”

「我累了。」

「**我也是。**」

Practice 19

> “I can work from home.”

> “**So can I.**”

「我可以在家工作。」

「**我也可以。**」

so + auxiliary + subject = 表示前面某個肯定情況同樣適用於另一個人 / 事物

The auxiliary changes:

* so **do** I

* so **am** I

* so **can** I

* so **have** I

* so **will** I

8. **so + subject + auxiliary (確認前述事實) — 的確如此 ; 果然是**

Be careful: the word order changes the meaning.

Practice 20

> “You said the café would be crowded.”

> “**So it is.**”

「你說咖啡店會很擠。」
「**果然如此 / 真的很擠。 **」

Practice 21

> “He looks tired.”
> “**So he does. **”

「他看起來很累。」
「**的確是。 **」

Compare:

> **So do I.** = 我也是
> **So I do.** = 我的確如此

This is excellent advanced grammar material.

9. **so = used to begin a conclusion/question/topic — 那麼；所以說；好了**

As a discourse marker, **so** often organizes conversation rather than carrying a literal causal meaning.

Practice 22

> “**So**, what do you think of the product?”

「**那麼**，你覺得這件產品怎樣？」

Practice 23

> “**So**, let’s look at the final result.”

「**好了 / 那麼**，我們來看看最後結果。」

so — discourse marker = 用來引出下一個問題、總結、決定或話題

This is extremely common in spoken English.

10. **so that + clause (目的) — 以便；為了讓.....**

This looks similar to ****so...that****, but it is different.

Practice 24

> “I wore the headphones ****so that**** I could focus.”

「我戴上耳機，****以便 / 為了讓自己能集中精神****。」

Practice 25

> “Speak clearly ****so that**** everyone can understand.”

「請說清楚一點，****好讓每個人都能明白****。」

****so that** = 引出行動的目的；為了使某件事能夠發生******

Compare:

Result:

> “It was ****so noisy that**** I couldn’t focus.”

「太嘈雜，****以致****我不能集中精神。」

Purpose:

> “I used headphones ****so that**** I could focus.”

「我使用耳機，****以便****集中精神。」

A very important distinction.

11. ****so as to + verb** (目的；較正式) — 為了；以便******

Practice 26

> “He lowered the volume ****so as to avoid**** disturbing others.”

「他調低音量，****以免 / 為了避免****打擾別人。」

Practice 27

> “The design was simplified ****so as to make**** it easier to use.”

「設計被簡化，**以便令它更容易使用**。」

****so as to + verb = 為了達成某個目的；較正式****

This is more formal than:

> to

> in order to

12. ****so much / so many (數量 / 程度) — 這麼多；如此多****

Practice 28

> “Why is there ****so much noise****?”

「為甚麼有****這麼多噪音****？」

Practice 29

> “There were ****so many people**** on the train.”

「火車上有****這麼多人****。」

****so much + uncountable noun = 這麼多.....****

****so many + plural countable noun = 這麼多.....****

13. ****so much = to such a great degree — 如此地；這麼厲害****

Practice 30

> “I like these headphones ****so much****.”

「我****非常喜歡****這副耳機。」

Practice 31

> “The noise bothered me ****so much****.”

「噪音****非常困擾我 / 令我很受不了****。」

****so much = 程度非常高；這麼 / 非常****

14. **so little / so few — 這麼少；如此少**

Practice 32

> “We had **so little time**.”

「我們只有**這麼少的時間**。」

Practice 33

> “There were **so few seats** available.”

「可用座位**少得很 / 只有這麼少**。」

so little = 不可數量這麼少

so few = 可數數量這麼少

15. **so far = until now / up to this point — 到目前為止；截至現在**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 34

> “**So far**, the headphones have worked perfectly.”

「**到目前為止**，這副耳機一直運作得很好。」

Practice 35

> “We have had no problems **so far**.”

「**截至目前為止**，我們沒有遇到任何問題。」

so far = 從較早時間一直計算到目前這個時間點

This expression does not mean literally “這麼遠” in this usage.

16. **so far = to such a distance/extent — 這麼遠；到這種程度**

A more literal meaning.

Practice 36

> “We had travelled **so far** that turning back made no sense.”

「我們已經走了**這麼遠**，回頭已經沒有意義。」

Practice 37

> “I can only go **so far** without more information.”

「沒有更多資料，我最多只能做到**這個程度**。」

so far = 達到某個距離或程度

So **so far** itself is polysemous:

* until now

* to this distance/extent

17. **so far, so good** — 到目前為止一切順利

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 38

> “How is the new job?”

> “**So far, so good.**”

「新工作怎樣？」

「**到目前為止都很順利。**」

Practice 39

> “Any problems with the headphones?”

> “No—**so far, so good.**”

「耳機有問題嗎？」

「沒有，**暫時一切都很好。**」

so far, so good = 目前為止沒有出現問題，情況令人滿意

18. **or so = approximately — 大約；左右**

A very useful expression.

Practice 40

> “It took an hour **or so**.”

「大約花了一個小時**左右**。」

Practice 41

> “There were twenty people **or so**.”

「大約有二十人**左右**。」

number/time + or so = 大約那個數量 / 時間，不是精確數字

19. **and so on = and other similar things — 等等；諸如此類**

Practice 42

> “The shop sells headphones, speakers, chargers, **and so on**.”

「這間店出售耳機、揚聲器、充電器**等等**。」

Practice 43

> “We discussed price, comfort, quality, **and so on**.”

「我們討論了價格、舒適度、品質**等等**。」

and so on = 表示還有其他同類例子，但不一一列出

Equivalent:

> etc.

20. **so-called + noun (名稱 / 稱號) — 所謂的；被稱為.....的**

A very useful family extension.

Practice 44

> “The **so-called** ‘premium’ model was disappointing.”

「那款**所謂的**『高級』型號令人失望。」

Practice 45

> “This is part of the **so-called** attention economy.”

「這是**所謂的**『注意力經濟』的一部分。」

so-called = 被人以某個名稱稱呼的；有時帶懷疑、諷刺或不認同語氣

Important nuance:

It can be neutral:

> “the **so-called** attention economy”

or skeptical:

> “his **so-called** friend”

= 他那個「所謂的朋友」

21. **not so + adjective** = less / not very — 沒那麼……；不太……

Practice 46

> “The cheaper model is **not so comfortable**.”

「較便宜的型號**沒那麼舒服**。」

Practice 47

> “The second half was **not so interesting**.”

「後半部分**沒有那麼有趣**。」

not so + adjective = 程度較低 / 不如前面所比較的那麼……

22. **so-so = only average / neither good nor bad — 馬馬虎虎；一般般**

A lexicalized extension.

Practice 48

> “How was the film?”

> “**So-so.**”

「電影怎樣？」

「**一般般。**」

Practice 49

> “The sound quality is only **so-so**.”

「音質只是**普普通通 / 馬馬虎虎**。」

so-so = 不特別好也不特別差；一般

This is informal.

Important distinction: **so = degree vs so = result**

Your passage gives us both.

Degree:

> “The train was **so noisy**...”

= 火車**這麼 / 非常嘈雜**

Result:

> “It mentioned practical features, **so** it felt believable.”

= 它提到實際功能，**所以**感覺可信。

Same spelling, completely different grammatical function.

Important distinction: **so...that vs so that**

This is crucial.

so + adjective + that

= degree → result

> “It was **so noisy that** I left.”

「太嘈雜，**以致**我離開。」

so that

= purpose

> “I left early **so that** I could avoid the traffic.”

「我提早離開，**以便**避開交通擠塞。」

Do not confuse them.

Important distinction: **so vs very**

very

simply intensifies:

> “It was very noisy.”

「非常嘈雜。」

so

often suggests:

- * a notably high degree;
- * an emotional/reactive tone;
- * or a following result.

> “It was so noisy!”

「真的太嘈雜了！」

> “It was so noisy that I left.”

「嘈雜得令我離開。」

So **so** often feels more expressive.

Important distinction: **so** vs **therefore**

so

very common in everyday speech/writing.

> “It was late, so we left.”

therefore

more formal/logical.

> “The evidence was insufficient; therefore, the claim was rejected.”

Both can mean 「因此」, but register differs.

Important distinction: **so** vs **then**

You just curated **then**.

so

usually gives a **result/consequence**:

> “It was noisy, so I left.”

「因為很嘈雜，所以我離開。」

then

usually gives:

* next event; or

* logical consequence after a condition.

> “I finished work, then I left.”

「完成工作後，我接著離開。」

So:

****so = 原因 → 結果****

****then = 前一步 → 下一步 / 條件 → 推論****

Important distinction: **so do I vs me too**

Both mean 「我也是」.

**So do I.**

more grammatical/formal structure and changes auxiliary according to the original sentence.

**Me too.**

more conversational and very simple.

> “I like the product.”

> “So do I.” / “Me too.”

Both natural.

Important distinction: **so do I vs so I do**

Very important:

> “I like coffee.”

> “****So do I.****”

= ****我也是。 ****

But:

> “You really like coffee.”

> “****So I do. ****”

= ****的確如此 / 我還真的很喜歡。 ****

Word order changes meaning.

Family-extension sweep

****So**** does not have a large derivational family. Its richness comes from grammatical functions and fixed expressions:

****so + adjective/adverb**** = 這麼 / 如此 / 非常
****so...that...**** = 如此.....以致.....
****so = therefore**** = 所以 / 因此
****so = in that way**** = 如此 / 這樣
****I think/hope so**** = 我想 / 希望如此
****so do I**** = 我也是
****so I do**** = 的確如此
****so — discourse marker**** = 那麼 / 好了
****so that**** = 以便 / 為了
****so as to**** = 為了 / 以便
****so much/many/little/few**** = 這麼多 / 這麼少
****so far — time**** = 到目前為止
****so far — distance/extent**** = 這麼遠 / 到這程度
****so far, so good**** = 目前為止一切順利
****or so**** = 大約 / 左右
****and so on**** = 等等
****so-called**** = 所謂的
****not so**** = 沒那麼.....
****so-so**** = 一般般

There is no need to invent obscure derivatives; the important learning value here is ****polyfunctionality****, not morphology.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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so + adjective/adverb	表示某種性質、狀態或方式達到很高程度；如此 / 這麼
so...that...	某種程度高到足以產生後面所述結果
so — therefore	前面的原因或情況造成後面的結果；所以 / 因此
so — in that way	以剛才所描述、展示或理解的方式；這樣 / 如此
I think/hope so	用 so 代替前面已提及的整個肯定命題
so do I	表示前面的肯定情況同樣適用於自己 / 另一對象
so I do	確認前述說法確實如此
so — discourse marker	用來引出下一個問題、決定、總結或話題
so that	引出行動的目的；以便 / 為了讓.....
so as to	較正式地表示某行動的目的
so much/many	表示不可數 / 可數數量達到很高程度

so little/few	表示不可數 / 可數數量非常少	
so far — time	從較早時間一直到目前為止	
so far — distance/extent	達到這麼遠的距離 / 這麼大的程度	
so far, so good	截至目前情況仍然令人滿意、沒有問題	
or so	表示數量、時間等只是約數；大約 / 左右	
and so on	表示仍有其他相似項目，不再一一列出	
so-called	被稱為某名稱的；有時帶懷疑或諷刺語氣	
not so	表示某種程度比比較對象低；沒那麼.....	
so-so	表現 / 品質普通，不好也不差	

For your passage

You actually have ****three important uses****:

> “the train was ****so noisy and crowded that****...”

****so = 程度如此高；嘈雜擠迫得.....****

> “it worked ****so well****...”

****so = 程度非常高；效果這麼好****

> “...the ad mentioned practical features, ****so**** it still felt believable.”

****so = 所以 / 因此****

So ****so**** was definitely a worthy addition: the passage itself demonstrates ****two different core functions****—****degree**** and ****cause → result****—before we even look at its wider English uses.